Third Audit Bell

Robert Jordan — original version: 6 June 2026
Documentary position described on the basis of materials available as of 4 June 2026.

> **Translation note — separate from the author's narrative:** Draft English reading translation of the selectable text of the Polish original, *Trzeci Dzwon Audytu*, `dzwon-3.pdf` (10 pages). This translation retains the original document's dates and evidential qualifications; it does not update the case to the date of translation. Documentary facsimiles remain in the Polish original. Each figure below has a translated caption and a reference to its original PDF page. Repeated running headers are represented by the author, version and documentary-cutoff lines above.

Is a signature enough without the issuer's version?

RDN, PUESC, ABW, MNiSW and KPRM: the document trail of a central authority

This text is the third part of a series concerning the case of Rafał Wróbel. The first part concerned the ZUT/RDN documents, the financing of legal services and the investigation that had been opened; the second concerned the unstable classification of the RDN act as an order or a decision and the consequences for the procedural route through RDN and the Voivodeship Administrative Court (WSA). This part narrows the issue to an audit question: who is to preserve the issuer's version, logs, metadata and circulation trail of a central authority's document?

Thesis

The matter concerns more than a single PDF file or an abstract assessment of an electronic signature. It concerns the auditability of a central authority's actions in proceedings with significant legal and public consequences: the ability to establish the issuer's version of a document, the source circulation logs, metadata, delivery channels, the relationships between document objects and the authority competent to preserve these data against loss.

Following the responses from ABW and MNiSW, and the referral of the matter to KPRM, a question remains unresolved: who within the state is responsible for preserving the issuer's version, logs, metadata and circulation trail of the RDN document if ABW considers the matter outside its subject-matter remit, MNiSW registers the matter and seeks a response from RDN but distances itself from determining the individual proceedings, and RDN remains the authority whose documents and document circulation require clarification?

1. Not one PDF, but at least two document objects

The first object is RDN letter DRKN.Z2.401.17.2023 of 18 October 2023, presented as a document signed with a qualified electronic signature. For one version in circulation, the PUESC report indicates a problem with the integrity of the signature and the signed object.

The second object is a one-page letter dated 19–20 October 2023, circulating as a letter concerning the initiation of invalidity proceedings. This object requires its own examination to establish its origin, its relationship to the RDN letter, its status within ZUT/RDN document circulation, the identification of its signature and seal, its metadata and its delivery channel.

No knowledge of PAdES or the technical details of signature validation is needed to see the basic problem: a document attributed to the Council of Scientific Excellence (RDN), the central authority competent in matters of academic advancement, is in circulation with a title containing “wszczęścia” instead of “wszczęcia” (the Polish word for “initiation”). The issue, however, is not a stylistic assessment of a document attributed to the Council of Scientific Excellence, but establishing whether RDN confirms that this is its own issuer’s version, or whether it is an incoming copy, a secondary reproduction or a document whose origin requires clarification.

Figure 1. Extract from the RDN letter of 18 October 2023: RDN links the invalidity proceedings concerning Rafał Wróbel’s habilitation to the proceedings for the title of professor as a preliminary issue, indicates the possibility of suspending the case, demands information from ZUT by 20 November 2023 and requests that the matter be treated as urgent.
Documentary facsimile: Polish original, PDF page 1.

Figure 2. The one-page object dated 19–20 October 2023, circulating as a letter concerning the initiation of invalidity proceedings. The visible linguistic and formal defects are not assessed here as a stylistic issue in their own right; instead, they reinforce the question of the document’s origin, the issuer’s version and the object’s status within ZUT/RDN document circulation.
Documentary facsimile: Polish original, PDF page 1.

The problem must therefore not be reduced to whether a single PDF opens. The question is: what document did the authority produce, what document was signed, what document was sent, what document was received and what document was subsequently used in institutional circulation?

2. PUESC: a firm signal, not a verdict in its own right

The submission to ABW cited the PUESC result: object integrity impaired / signature invalid, together with the lack of access to the issuer’s version and circulation logs. The PUESC result does not automatically determine the cause of the discrepancy or the responsibility of any particular person. It is, however, a firm signal that the version in circulation needs to be compared with the issuer’s version and that the source circulation trail needs to be preserved.

Figure 3. PUESC report: an invalid/incorrect result for the file presented as RDN letter DRKN.Z2.401.17.2023, together with messages indicating impairment of the signed object’s integrity.
Documentary facsimile: Polish original, PDF page 2.

3. Submission to ABW: legal basis and request for a legal hold

The submission of 7 February 2026 identified a legal basis for ABW’s jurisdiction and referred to CSIRT GOV as the governmental incident-response team. It concerned the circulation of a central authority’s document in electronic form and the risk of compromising the verifiability of a document signed with a qualified electronic signature and of its distribution channels.

Most importantly, however, the submission did not merely characterise the problem; it also requested the preservation of evidence: the issuer's version, EZD logs, ePUAP/e-Doręczenia logs, confirmations, attachments and checksums, together with protection against retention-related loss or overwriting.

Figure 4. Submission to ABW of 7 February 2026: legal basis, PUESC, the issuer's version, logs and the request for a legal hold.
Documentary facsimile: Polish original, PDF page 3.

4. ABW's first response: narrowing the matter to the absence of a computer-security incident

Letter B-5899/2026 indicates that ABW acknowledged receipt of the submission and took the position that the event described did not constitute a computer-security incident and did not fall within the Agency's subject-matter remit. That classification determines the computer-security-incident category, but it does not remove the question of which authority is competent to preserve the issuer's version, logs and metadata.

This matters because the original focus of the submission was the issuer's version, logs and the verifiability of a central authority's document circulation. If ABW considered itself not competent, the key question becomes whether—and which—authority should preserve the source material.

Figure 5. ABW's first response, B-5899/2026: a reference to the publication in *Forum Akademickie*, the absence of classification as a computer-security incident and the absence of ABW's subject-matter jurisdiction.
Documentary facsimile: Polish original, PDF page 4.

5. Supplement: the RDN document and system records, rather than a press publication

Following ABW's response, the submission was clarified. The supplement of 25 March 2026 stated that the subject was neither a press publication nor its use in public circulation. The essence of the matter was doubt concerning the integrity of the official RDN document DRKN.Z2.401.17.2023, the relationships between the different objects in document circulation and the need to preserve system-source material capable of establishing the actual origin, content and history of those documents.

The supplement specifically listed the official RDN letter, wrappers or delivery objects in the RDN documentation, the separate one-page document dated 19–20 October 2023 and the source system records associated with the creation, signing, sending, receipt and storage of the materials.

Figure 6. Supplement to the submission to ABW of 25 March 2026: clarification that the matter concerns the official RDN document, wrappers, the second document object and source system records.
Documentary facsimile: Polish original, PDF page 5.

The supplement also stated that ZUT refuses to provide the source EML/MSG message with full headers, indicates a limited retention period for Microsoft 365 logs and maintains that it is not the authority competent to preserve evidence.

6. ABW's second response: maintaining its position

Following the supplement, ABW maintained its earlier position. In its letter of April 2026, the Agency stated that a renewed analysis of the problem did not lead it to regard the matter as a computer-security incident or as a matter falling within ABW's subject-matter remit.

The problem does not disappear, however, because classification as a computer-security incident is declined. The question remains: which state authority is to preserve the issuer's version, EZD, ePUAP and e-Doręczenia logs, metadata and the circulation trail of a central authority's document?

Figure 7. ABW's second response, B-9833/2026: maintaining the position that there was no computer-security incident and no ABW subject-matter jurisdiction.
Documentary facsimile: Polish original, PDF page 6.

7. MNiSW: registering the matter, seeking RDN's response and indicating the limits of its jurisdiction

In parallel, the Ministry of Science and Higher Education (MNiSW) registered the matter under reference DN-WAN.580.3.2026 and asked RDN to present its position and explanations. At the same time, it indicated that it was neither appropriate nor justified for the Ministry to formulate binding or detailed opinions concerning appeal proceedings in individual cases.

This creates a practical gap: RDN is the authority whose documents and document circulation are being questioned; ABW declines jurisdiction; MNiSW seeks a response from RDN but distances itself from assessing the individual proceedings. An answer is still missing as to who preserves the source audit trail.

Figure 8. MNiSW letter DN-WAN.580.3.2026: registration of the matter and a request to RDN, while distancing itself from the substance of the individual proceedings.
Documentary facsimile: Polish original, PDF page 7.

8. KPRM / Minister-Coordinator: the question of the competent authority

Consequently, on 4 June 2026 a request was submitted to KPRM / the Minister-Coordinator for Special Services for an assessment of ABW's position, identification of the competent authority and preservation of the audit trail of the RDN documents. This step does not establish that ABW was obliged to handle the matter. It does, however, clarify the institutional question: if not ABW, then who is to preserve the issuer's version, logs, metadata and circulation channels of a central authority's document?

The proof of receipt in e-Doręczenia confirms that the correspondence was delivered to KPRM on 4 June 2026. A response, or the absence of one, will not yet determine the merits of the case, but will become another element in the map of institutional responsibility.

Figure 9. Request to KPRM / the Minister-Coordinator for Special Services of 4 June 2026: the submission package's particulars and the question of the authority competent to preserve the trail.
Documentary facsimile: Polish original, PDF page 8.

Figure 10. Proof of KPRM's receipt of the correspondence through e-Doręczenia on 4 June 2026. *Documentary facsimile: Polish original, PDF page 9.*

9. Scope of this part

This text deliberately concerns only the circulation and identity of the document: the issuer's version, the PUESC result, delivery channels, metadata and logs that make it possible to reconstruct the file's history. It does not determine other aspects of the case and does not seek to do so.

In this part, the question is narrow: can the central authority and the competent institutions identify what document was produced, how it was signed, sent, received and stored, and what data make it possible to reconstruct its circulation?

The question of the documents' origin is also connected with the question of the legal and evidential basis for the expectation that a ZUT authority would take steps towards initiating invalidity proceedings in respect of Rafał Wróbel's habilitation. If the RDN document invoked urgency arising from the expiry of a ten-year time limit, it is all the more necessary to establish what source materials, opinions, document versions and procedural routes formed the basis for that expectation. This matters particularly because the case has entered a formal prosecutorial process, and earlier materials described, among other things, problems involving multiple versions of documents, external legal services, the financing of those services and the need to preserve storage media, metadata and logs. This text does not determine those issues, but shows why the question of the issuer's version and the source circulation trail of the RDN document is not a technical detail, but a condition for conducting proceedings safely.

The prosecutorial track of the case will require a separate study, including the earlier and current actions of prosecution offices in Szczecin and the proceedings currently being conducted in Kraków. In this text, that aspect appears only insofar as it demonstrates the need to preserve sources, metadata, logs and document versions.

Conclusion

Following the responses from ABW and MNiSW, and the referral of the matter to KPRM, a question remains that cannot be reduced to the outcome of an individual's academic-advancement proceedings: who within the state is responsible for preserving the issuer's version, logs, metadata and circulation trail of a central authority's document?

ABW considered that the matter did not constitute a computer-security incident and did not fall within the Agency's jurisdiction. MNiSW registered the matter and sought RDN's position, but at the same time indicated that it was not appropriate to formulate binding opinions in individual proceedings. RDN remains the authority whose documents and document circulation are the subject of the central question.

In this situation, the problem does not disappear. On the contrary, it becomes a question of the state's basic ability to preserve the trail of its own procedures. If a central authority's document functions in several layers of circulation, and one of the objects shows an integrity problem in the PUESC report, the response cannot consist solely of stating that the matter does not fit within one category of computer-security incident.

The first task is to establish what document RDN produced, what its issuer's version was, how it was signed, sent, received and stored, what logs make it possible to reconstruct this and which authority is responsible for preserving those data against loss.

Sources and attachments

- RDN letter DRKN.Z2.401.17.2023 of 18 October 2023.
- The one-page letter dated 19–20 October 2023, circulating as a letter concerning the initiation of invalidity proceedings.
- PUESC report for DRKN.Z2.401.17.2023 — an invalid/incorrect result and messages indicating impairment of the signed object's integrity.
- Submission to ABW of 7 February 2026 — legal basis, PUESC, the issuer's version, logs and a legal hold.
- ABW response B-5899/2026 of February 2026 — the initial narrowing to the absence of a computer-security incident and the absence of ABW's subject-matter jurisdiction.
- Supplement to ABW of 25 March 2026.
- ABW response of April 2026 maintaining its position.
- MNiSW letter of 2 June 2026, DN-WAN.580.3.2026.WP.
- Request to KPRM / the Minister-Coordinator for Special Services of 4 June 2026.
- Confirmation of KPRM's receipt of the correspondence through e-Doręczenia, dated 4 June 2026.